

Weaknesses of Weimar Republic

Weimar Constitution

as with any democracy ⇒ new republic needed a constitution.

Even though constitution was approved by majority in the Reichstag ⇒ there were a number of representatives who voted against it.

→ early worrying sign

New constitution ⇒ introduced significant changes.

- All Germans over the age of 20 could vote ⇒ with women being included for the first time
- Party representation in Reichstag ⇒ would be determined by proportional representation

Strengths of Weimar Govt	Weaknesses of Weimar Govt
- proportional representation ⇒ meant that any party taking part in the elections ⇒ would gain seats in the Reichstag ⇒ equal to the number of votes that it received. ⇒ example: if party received 20% of the votes, it would gain 20% of seats in the Reichstag → allowed most views and interests being represented in the reichstag. - Laws ⇒ had to be approved by the Reichstag ⇒ chancellor could not just push them through → this prevented the abuse of power.	- hard for one party to gain a majority. ⇒ even parties opposed to democracy ⇒ like German communist party ⇒ could gain seats in the Reichstag. → governments ended up as coalitions ⇒ which made it hard for the Reichstag to pass laws. → led to governments that were weak and often short lived. - Article 48 ⇒ was a double edged sword. ⇒ it could be used to protect + preserve democracy → but presidents with different attitudes towards democracy could misuse + exploit it. → could be a threat to the constitution.

President ⇒ Ebert ⇒ wanted to bring about measures and reforms which would benefit millions of Germans ⇒ but he could not do so due to internal and external problems (with reference to the republic.

Treaty of Versailles

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Threats to the Republic

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- Spartacist Uprising, 1919
 - Kapp Putsch, 1920
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Economic Challenges

Occupation of Ruhr and Hyperinflation
